



**NATION
BUILDERS**

SPIRIT OF INDIA SPECIAL

TATA STEEL Established 1907

With a turnover of over Rs 1,47,000 crore, Tata Steel is not only a steel giant but also a 102-year-old legend, having introduced the eight-hour work day in 1912 and a Provident Fund in 1920

STEELING THE WORLD

One of the largest steel manufacturers in the world, Tata Steel was born during India's struggle for Independence when an inspired Jamsetji Nusserwanji Tata set up Asia's first-ever privately owned integrated iron and steel plant in 1907. The company has come a long way since then. Its acquisition of Corus pitchforked it to the global top 10 list of steel producers. But mere numbers don't satisfy this legendary company. Tata Steel India was awarded the Deming Application Prize 2008 for excellence in Total Quality Management—the first company outside Japan to get the award. It was rated the world's best steel maker for two consecutive years by *World Steel Dynamics* in its listing in February 2006. In recognition of its performance the company has been conferred the Prime Minister of India's Trophy for the Best Integrated Steel Plant five times and also awarded Asia's Most Admired Knowledge Enterprise award five times (2003, 2004, 2006, 2007 and 2008.)

Though the global meltdown affected the company, it found ways to stay ahead. With a turnover of over Rs 1,47,000 crore in 2008-2009, the company faced the slowdown by pursuing its long-term strategy of acquiring and developing mining projects at logistically favourable locales near its plants in Europe and Asia. The company's philosophy is best summed up in the words of its 65-year-old managing director, B. Muthuraman, who says: "Tata Steel's longevity bears testimony to its long-term approach and its ability to embrace

54 million
tonnes is India's
production of
steel, of which
Tata Steel's
Jamshedpur
plant produces
6.8 million
tonnes.



SANJAY RAMACHANDRAN

B. Muthuraman 65, MD

"We remain committed to our long-term strategy. Our belief about the attractiveness of the steel industry has not been dented."

change with ease."

Tata Steel has gone beyond its manufacturing duties to give India a lot more. It trained the first batch of engineers who worked at the government's steel plants in Bhilai, Rourkela and Durgapur. It introduced an eight-hour work day in 1912 and leave-with-pay in 1920—ushered in the rest of India only in 1945. Its employees had a Provident Fund in 1920, years before it became a national law. The workers too have reciprocated—the company's furnaces have never been closed on

account of labour unrest.

By 1911, Jamshedpur, which was then the heart of rural, underdeveloped Bihar, had electricity, water, sanitation and public health services. Tata Steel impacts the lives of over 10 lakh people in villages across Jharkhand, Orissa and Chhattisgarh and at its operational locations, making it the first steel company in the world to receive the Social Accountability 8000 certification from Social Accountability International, USA. Not just that, the company commissioned 1.8 million tonnes of crude steel making capacity at Jamshedpur in 2008-09 with plans to augment it by three million tonnes by 2011. It is clear: the future is steel.

By Elora Sen